



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Thursday 17 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 20 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A strong high pressure system centred over Victoria will maintain a ridge across SA as it drifts slowly over NSW from Friday. A cold front will then approach from the west late Saturday and move across SA on Sunday, before another ridge pushes in behind the front. The associated high will then move eastwards across waters south from Monday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning west to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Port Vincent to Brighton. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 17 September until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly in the morning then decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 19 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Sunday 20 September

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots shifting southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.